Using slang when speaking to Gen Z and Gen Alpha

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Have you ever felt disconnected when talking with your students? Every new generation creates its own vocabulary, also known as *slang*, and the feeling of disconnection between older and younger generations just amplifies with each generation. However, the usage of slang can have positive outcomes when it comes to its usage in a classroom such as students feeling comprehended and teachers attracting students' attention in heavy lectures.

Firstly, learning how to speak our students' language will have a highly positive rapport with them, due to the instant effect on comprehending students' cultural world. This decision can, consequently, lower the affective filter inside the classroom, changing their negative perspective towards the standard English classes to an open-mindedness and lower their anxiety levels, fostering a more comfortable class for both parties. In other words, making use of their language can create a more comfortable, more productive environment.

Secondly, teachers can implement jokes in specially heavy lectures such as teaching them comparatives and superlatives to prove this idea. Adding several sentences that include proper terminology that uses their very own language, will help students to engage more easily in lessons and consolidate new knowledge in a shorter period of time rather than only teaching them in the standard or formal language in English. This will help students on connecting their previous knowledge to the newest, alongside their personal experiences.

The usage of slang inside the classroom can be utterly beneficial for both students and teachers when used as a tool to learn. Using a language in common that is well-known by our students can help lowering the affective filter and make classes enjoyable and memorable. Also, teachers can use these slangs to make their classes lighter and engage their students from the very beginning of their lecture. Overall, using slang when speaking with our new generations doesn't make our interactions more enjoyable, but can make an interesting break from the curriculum.